The Frontier AI Risk Quick–Check

A free instrument from AI GOVERNANCE CHAIN™

Most AI governance assumes a bounded, predictable system. Frontier and highly autonomous systems break that assumption. This quick-check tells you whether your system has crossed into frontier territory, where ordinary governance is not enough.

Abbreviations and Acronyms

No prior knowledge is assumed. Every acronym used in this document is defined below.

AI: Artificial Intelligence

AGI: Artificial General Intelligence

Why this matters (the WHY)

The most advanced systems, large frontier models and agentic systems that plan and act, carry risks that conventional controls were never designed for: emergent capability, autonomous action, and failure at a speed and scale a human cannot intercept. Governing them like ordinary software is the gap that worries regulators most.

The Quick-Check (the WHAT)

Answer yes or no. Any yes means frontier-grade governance is warranted.

1. 1. Does the system act autonomously (plan, decide, or execute) without a human approving each step?
2. 2. Can it use tools, call other systems, or trigger real-world actions?
3. 3. Are its capabilities broad or general rather than narrow and fixed?
4. 4. Could its behavior change or emerge in ways the builders did not explicitly design?
5. 5. Could a failure propagate faster than a human could intervene?
6. 6. Could it affect critical infrastructure, safety, or large populations?
7. 7. Is it among the most capable models or agents available?

Reading your result

- - Zero yes: Conventional. Standard governance applies.
- - One to three yes: Elevated. Frontier-grade controls needed in those areas.
- - Four or more yes: Frontier. Full frontier governance is required before scaling.

Where this stops (the boundary)

This check flags frontier status. The paid Frontier and AGI Governance Kit provides the capability thresholds, the evaluation protocol, and the containment and stop architecture that govern such systems.

AI GOVERNANCE CHAIN™ | AI Governance Framework

(c) 2026 Mathieu K. Gouanou. All rights reserved.

Member, Harvard Business Review Advisory Council.

Document standard: human-first AI governance.